CITY MIRROR

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India, EU finalise landmark trade agreement



India–EU leaders meet in New Delhi to strengthen trade relations.

Source: Asianet News English

Kolkata, January 29: lindia and the European Union concluded negotiations on a long-pending Free Trade Agreement (FTA) on January 27, 2026, ending 18 years of talks held in New Delhi and Brussels. The pact aims to reduce major tariffs and triple bilateral trade by 2030, with a focus on sectors such as automobiles, agriculture, and technology. Under the agreement, India will cut duties on over 96% of EU goods, including reducing tariffs on European cars from 110% to 10%. In return, the EU will remove tariffs on 99% of Indian exports, benefiting labour-intensive sectors such as textiles and leather. The agreement will now move to ratification in both India and the EU. Analysts said the pact would significantly boost trade and investment ties between the two economies.

— Palak Singh

Nipah Virus: Doctor clears doubts

Kolkata, January 30: A doctor at Bansal Hospital said no cases of the Nipah virus have been reported at the hospital so far, offering reassurance amid public concern. However, the doctor noted that two to three hospital staff members in Kolkata have been affected, prompting hospitals across the city to remain alert and cautious.

Explaining the nature of the infection, the doctor said the Nipah virus primarily originates from fruit bats and is commonly transmitted when humans consume fruits contaminated with bat saliva. The virus spreads when bats bite or partially eat fruits and leave saliva on them, which may infect humans if such fruits are later consumed. Human-to-human transmission is rare but not impossible, particularly in close-contact settings.In suspected cases, the virus can be detected through saliva testing, The doctor further described the symptoms of Nipah virus infection, which include stomach pain, vomiting, and respiratory problems, and stressed the importance of seeking immediate medical attention if such symptoms appear.Referring to past outbreaks, the doctor said that when the Nipah virus was first identified, the mortality rate was extremely high at around 91 per cent. Over the years, however, improved medical care, increased awareness, and faster response mechanisms have helped reduce the mortality rate to approximately 33 per cent.Health officials said surveillance has been intensified across hospitals in the city, with isolation facilities and screening protocols kept ready as a precautionary measure.

— Tamanna Baid

Vande Bharat sleeper begins new era

Kolkata,January29: India's first Vande Bharat Sleeper Express was inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on January 17 at Malda Town station, marking the expansion of the Vande Bharat service into overnight long-distance travel.The premium train will operate between Howrah and Kamakhya, improving rail connectivity between eastern and northeastern India.The 16-coach, fully air-conditioned train offers AC First, AC Two-Tier, and AC Three-Tier sleeper classes, along with modern safety systems and upgraded onboard amenities.The service is scheduled to begin operations on January 22, 2026, and will run six days a week.Railway officials said the new train will reduce travel time compared to existing long-distance express services while offering greater comfort and safety for passengers.Major halts along the route include Bandel, New Farakka, New Jalpaiguri, and New Bongaigaon.Officials said bookings have witnessed a strong public response.

— Kashish Shaw

CITY

Road accidents decline as rules get stricter, says traffic police



Traffic rules under close watch
Source - Telegraph India

Kolkata,January22: Road accidents in the city have declined as compliance with traffic rules has improved, a traffic police officer said.Drink-and-drive cases have reduced due to stricter enforcement and higher fines, though highways remain accident-prone because of high speeds.Police said enforcement drives will continue across the city. Officials also urged motorists to remain cautious.

— Udita Verma

Kolkata's 'Sahityer Feriwala' Refuses to Let Reading Fade

Kolkata,January 24: At the Kolkata International Book Fair, Alok Kumar Dutta stands out for selling ₹10 booklets and promoting a lifelong commitment to reading. For over five decades, he has been a familiar presence at the fair, earning titles such as "Sahityer Feriwala" from AIR Kolkata presenter Partha Ghosh and "Ekaler Dadathakur" from Shyamal Das of Murshidabad SandeshPatrika.Dutta



The Literature Hawker: Fifty years of joy through booklets
Source - Tamali Mukhopadhyay

believes literature should be accessible to all, especially at a time when books are becoming increasingly expensive. His low-cost booklets aim to ensure that everyone can enjoy reading. His short stories reflect a pre-digital era, capturing childhood mischief, shared laughter, and the close-knit communities of earlier generations.Challenging the notion that young people are losing interest in books, Dutta said that many young readers still show genuine enthusiasm for literature

.— Tamali Mukhopadhyay

Woman facing domestic abuse finally speaks up

Kolkata, January 30: A woman from Jorabagan has accused her husband of repeated physical and mental harassment, police said on Thursday.The complainant, Kiran Singh, who is currently staying at her maternal home, filed a complaint against her husband, Amit Sonkar, at Golabari Police Station in Howrah.According to the complaint, Singh alleged that she was subjected to frequent abuse over a prolonged period, resulting in both physical and emotional distress. Sources said the alleged incidents created an atmosphere of fear within the household.Unable to endure the situation any further, Singh approached the police seeking legal action. Police officer Sudip Singh confirmed that the complaint has been registered and that an investigation is underway.Police said appropriate steps will be taken after reviewing the findings of the inquiry. The case has drawn attention to concerns over domestic violence and the need for stronger support mechanisms for survivors.Police added that statements are being recorded and further action will follow as per procedure. The accused has not yet issued any statement regarding the allegations.

— Tamali Mukhopadhyay

Tax Dodger Nabbed: Arrest Warrant Ends Court Absence Drama

Kolkata,January 31: Sourav Maity was arrested on Thursday for repeatedly ignoring court summons in a tax non-payment case. Court sources said Maity failed to clear outstanding taxes and skipped multiple hearings despite being directed to appear before the Alipore Court. Taking serious note of his repeated absence, the court issued a warrant of arrest on January 30, 2026. Acting on the order, HowrahPolicearrested Maity the same day and placed him in custody.Officials said the arrest was necessary to enforce the law and send a strong message against tax evasion and non-compliance with court orders. Maity will be produced before the court for further proceedings. Further investigation is ongoing, and authorities warned against ignoring judicial orders

.— Kashish Shaw

ENTERTAINMENT AND LIFESTYLE

Young Hearts at Risk: Lifestyle and Sleep Deprivation Fuel Cardiac Cases

Kolkata,January30: Dr. Debashish, Resident Medical Officer(RMO), warned that heart attacks are increasingly affecting younger Indians due to unhealthy lifestyles, citing lack of sleep, poor diet, physical inactivity, and rising diabetes as key risk factors.Sleep deprivation—especially among night-shift workers—raises cortisol and cholesterol levels and increases blood pressure, placing additional strain on the heart.He also cautioned against junk and high-fat



Young hearts under pressure—lifestyle choices taking a deadly toll.

Source-Indian Express

foods and highlighted India's growing sedentary lifestyle, noting that prolonged sitting has replaced natural physical activity.Calling diabetes a "silent killer," he stressed its damaging impact on the heart and kidneys.He advised ECG and blood glucose (CBG) tests every six months for adults over 30 and screening for high-risk youth. He also warned against ignoring symptoms such as fatigue, chest discomfort, or breathlessness.Dr. Debashish urged people to maintain regular exercise, balanced nutrition, adequate sleep, and routine health check-ups, stressing that prevention remains the most effective defence against heart disease.

— Harshika Baid

Fujifilm Brings Retro Charm to India with Instax Mini Evo

Kolkata,January19: Fujifilm has launched the Instax Mini Evo camera in India at ₹47,999, combining a retro design with modern features.The camera captures photos and 15-second video clips, instantly printing images with QR codes that allow users to replay associated videos.It features an "Effects Dial" with options such as 1960s film grain, 1970s colour tones, and 1980s negative effects, each with adjustable intensity levels.Inspired by vintage cameras, the device includes a vertical grip and a print lever for a nostalgic touch. Through a companion app, users can edit videos, design posters, and print photos directly from smartphones.Pre-bookings will run from January 21 to 27, with deliveries beginning January 28. Buyers will receive a bonus designer film pack.The launch targets photography enthusiasts seeking a blend of instant prints and digital creativity. The company said the camera is aimed at content creators and young users who value both instant prints and digital sharing.Fujifilm hopes to strengthen its presence in the premium instant camera segment with this launch.

— Tamanna Baid

Stranger Things S5: Binge Worthy or Not?

Kolkata,January17: Stranger Things returned with its fifth and final season on Netflix, released in three volumes between November 26 and December 31,2025.Set in Hawkins, Indiana, the series follows a group of teenagers battling supernatural forces.Season 5 centres on the disappearance of Holly Wheeler as the group once again confronts Vecna. Millie Bobby Brown



Stranger Things S5: One Last Fight Against The Darkness

Source-India Tv News

received praise for her portrayal of Eleven, while Noah Schnapp was appreciated for Will Byers' character development.The season also brought back several familiar faces, strengthening the emotional depth of the storyline. High-intensity action sequences and darker themes marked a shift in tone compared to earlier seasons.While the season largely met expectations, some viewers felt the ending could have been stronger.

— Udita Verma

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SPORTS

Kohli's Lone Roar in Indore



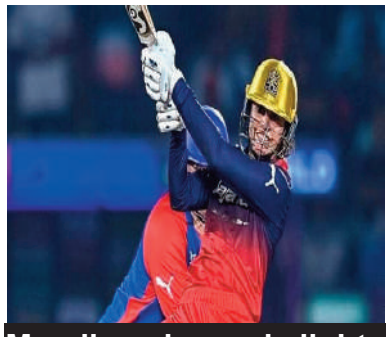
Virat Kohli composes glorious 54th ODI century

Source-Cricbuzz

Kolkata, January19: Virat Kohli once again stood tall under pressure, scoring his 54th ODI century against New Zealand in the third ODI at Indore on Sunday. Chasing 337, he reached the milestone in 91 balls, striking eight fours and two sixes.With wickets falling at the other end, Kohli anchored the chase and strengthened his reputation as one of the finest finishers in ODI cricket.

- Harshika Baid

Mandhana Stars as RCB Clinch Second WPL Title



Mandhana's magic lights up WPL final

Source:BBC

Kolkata, February 6: Royal Challengers Bengaluru scripted one of the most thrilling run chases in Women's Premier League (WPL) history to defeat Delhi Capitals and claim their second title, handing the Capitals a fourth successive defeat in a final.Chasing a daunting 204,RCB showed composure under pressure to seal victory with two balls to spare in a high-scoring summit clash.After an early setback, captain Smriti Mandhana and Australia's Georgia Voll stitched together a record 165-run partnership that turned the tide of the contest. Mandhana struck 87 off just 41 deliveries, while Voll anchored the innings with a steady 79 off 54 balls, ensuring the required rate never spiralled out of control.Tension returned when Voll departed with 30 runs still needed, and Richa Ghosh followed soon after, bringing the equation down to the final overs. Mandhana was bowled in the penultimate over, leaving the lower order with a tricky task. Radha Yadav, dropped off her first ball, struck two crucial boundaries in the final over to seal a memorable win. Earlier, Delhi Capitals had posted 203 for 4 — the highest total in a WPL final — with Jemimah Rodrigues scoring 57, Laura Wolvaardt 44, and Chinelle Henry an unbeaten 35 off 15 balls. Despite the defeat,Capitals skipper Rodrigues praised her team's resilience

- Palak Singh

Big Wins, Small Spotlight: Women Athletes Still Seek Equal Visibility



Where passion meets power.
Source - Olympics.com

Kolkata,January 20: Despite consistent high-level performances, women athletes in India continue to struggle for sustained visibility compared to their male counterparts.A recent example is hurdler Jyothi Yarraji, who won gold in the 100-metre hurdles at the 2023 Asian Athletics Championships in front of a sparsely attended crowd, highlighting the limited attention often given to women's sporting success.The pattern extends across disciplines. Six-time world boxing champion Mary Kom has not always received the sustained media focus accorded to male athletes with comparable achievements. Badminton star PV Sindhu captured nationwide attention after her Olympic silver medal, yet coverage of women's sport remains inconsistent, while men's events dominate regular headlines and promotional campaigns.In cricket, players such as Smriti Mandhana and Harmanpreet Kaur have delivered consistent international performances, but women's matches rarely receive prime-time promotion or equal marketing support.Analysts note that limited exposure directly affects sponsorship opportunities, fan engagement, and the overall development of women's sports.Experts argue that meaningful change requires sustained intent — including regular prime-time broadcasts, stronger storytelling, and equal commercial investment from sponsors and broadcasters. Until women's sport is treated as a long-term investment, the coverage gap will remain.

— Prarthana Khanna